

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Kusuma Medasani

Address: 38 Belmont Rise Cheam SM2 6EQ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally object to the proposed development on the following material planning grounds:

1. Increased Traffic and Highway Safety Concerns

The proposed development is likely to generate a significant increase in vehicle movements, particularly during peak hours. This will add further pressure to an already congested local road network. The surrounding streets are residential in nature and were not designed to accommodate additional high volumes of traffic.

Increased vehicle movements will lead to:

Congestion at junctions and narrow residential streets

Reduced visibility for pedestrians and drivers

Unsafe manoeuvres, including informal drop-offs and turning movements

Greater risk of obstruction to emergency vehicles

This raises serious highway safety concerns and conflicts with the requirement to ensure safe and suitable access for all road users.

2. Impact on Vulnerable Residents (Care Home Proximity)

The site is located close to a care home accommodating elderly and potentially mobility-impaired residents. These individuals are particularly vulnerable to:

Increased traffic noise and disturbance

Air pollution from additional vehicle emissions

Unsafe crossing conditions due to higher vehicle flow

Any intensification of activity in this location risks materially affecting the health, wellbeing, and quality of life of these vulnerable residents. Planning decisions must give appropriate weight to the impact on sensitive uses such as care facilities.

3. Late-Night Disturbance and Residential Amenity

The development has the potential to generate late evening or night-time activity, including vehicle arrivals/departures, door slamming, engine idling, and general noise associated with gatherings.

This would result in:

Noise disturbance during traditionally quiet hours

Loss of peaceful enjoyment of neighbouring homes

Light pollution from vehicle headlights and external lighting

Such impacts would harm residential amenity and would be contrary to policies aimed at protecting the character and tranquillity of established residential areas.

4. Impact on Local Schools and Child Safety

The development is situated within an area that includes local schools and established school drop-off/pick-up routes. These times already experience:

High pedestrian volumes (including young children and parents with buggies)

Significant on-street parking pressure

Congestion and reduced visibility at crossings

Additional traffic generated by the proposal would exacerbate existing congestion and materially increase the risk to child safety. The cumulative impact during peak school hours is a serious concern and must be given substantial weight.

5. Visual Impact and Character of the Area

The proposed development appears visually overbearing and out of keeping with the established architectural character of the neighbourhood. The surrounding properties are predominantly residential in scale and design.